INDEPENDENT, ALTERNATIVE, AND COMMUNITY MEDIA AN OPEN READER

Edited and with an introduction by
David W. Park & Meghan Grosse

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Independent, Alternative, and Community Media: An Open Reader

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Punks' Jungle: São Paulo

Rodrigo Lopes de Barros

In *Distortion and Subversion: Punk Rock Music and the Protests for Free Public Transportation in Brazil (1996–2011)*, 229–68. Liverpool University Press, 2022. https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctv3029s28.9.

I looked at the distant city down there . . . I did start to think that neither I nor anybody else would ever manage to understand all that because it was perhaps impossible to feel what that city was, because the city was precisely made so that nobody managed to understand what it was, because it was exactly that, a bunch of things without a beginning and without an end.

The punk narrator from the novel *Fliperama sem creme* by Teixeira Coelho, describing São Paulo, 1984.[1]

After the Crossroads, the Network

São Paulo undoubtedly stands as the most important city in Brazil. Just over an hour's flying time from Florianópolis lies the largest metropolis in the Southern Hemisphere. Its chaotic agglomeration of buildings extends beyond the horizon. At night, the multitude of lights eclipses the brightness of the stars, and on a dry day, the smoke emitted by factories and cars seems to be transmuted into a massive gray cloud. One cannot compare the scale of these two places. Florianópolis has been portrayed as an idyllic island forgotten in the Atlantic, while São Paulo signifies a "forest of concrete and steel," as stated in a rap song by Racionais MC's, or "an urban inferno," in the words of historian Nicolau Sevcenko.[2] São Paulo exists as a hellish jungle of social and physical human-made structures (if one combines both). In the same vein, the punk band B.U.S.H. released an album named after the city in 2007, and the cover art of the LP displays the skyscrapers of São Paulo. The yellow and blue layer situated

[1] Teixeira Coelho, *Fliperama sem creme* (São Paulo: Brasiliense, 1984), 76–77 (emphasis in original).

[2] Racionais MC's, "Negro Drama," disc 1, track 5 on *Nada como um dia após o outro dia* (São Paulo: Cosa Nostra, 2002), CD; Nicolau Sevcenko cited in Alexandra Perloff- Giles, "Brazil's Public Intellectual," Harvard Gazette, Oct. 21, 2010, https://news.harvard.edu/gazette/story/2010/10/brazils-public-intellectual/; see also: Steinmacher, *Sons de uma ilha subterrânea, 33.*

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under the image of edifices reveals that the metropolis is, at the same time, psychedelic and full of surprises. Among the published songs is one titled "Andando pelas ruas" ("Roaming the Streets"); the lyrics depict the contradictory feelings of São Paulo's inhabitants. They want to flee but, at the same time, they nourish love for their city. The punks and the bandits—and not the famous singer Caetano Veloso, as he portrays in "Sampa"—are the ones who walk through the crossroads of Ipiranga and São João avenues.[3] Punks are *flâneurs* observing the effervescence of the urban space. They also announce that the economic heart of the country still pulses at night. São Paulo is a tough environment where virtually all imaginable possibilities live.

Relação de amor e ódio com esse lugar
Já tentei fugir daqui, sem-
pre acabo por voltar
Medo, corrupção e violência
Mais uma noite chega pra te convidar
Já passa de meia noite, o metrô vai fechar
Um punk atravessa a Ipiranga
O rolê vai começar
Muitos vão pra Augusta, procurar diversão
Enquanto os delinquentes
apavoram na Avenida São João

A love-hate relationship with this place
I've already tried to escape, I al-
ways keep coming back
Fear, corruption, and violence
Another night arrives to invite you along
It's past midnight, subways closing soon
A punk crosses Ipiranga Ave.
The night out's going to start
Many go to Augusta St. looking for fun
While the delinquents
raise hell at São João Ave.

[2X]
Não há gratidão, nem piedade
pelas ruas dessa cidade
No cair da madrugada, o centro vai ferver
Não fecharei os olhos um minuto sequer
Respiro, vivo, sigo...
Respiro, vivo, sigo...

[2X]
There's no gratitude, no piety
on the streets of this city
In the small hours, downtown is gonna burn
Won't close my eyes, even for a blink
I breathe, live, move forward...
I breathe, live, move forward...

[2X]
Andando pelas ruas de São Paulo
Andando pelas ruas!!!
Andando pelas ruas de São Paulo
Andando pelas ruas!!!... de São Paulo

[2X]
Roaming the streets of São Paulo
Roaming the streets!!!
Roaming the streets of São Paulo
Roaming the streets!!!... of São Paulo[4]

Everything in Brazil happens first in São Paulo. However, this axiom was shattered at least once: here, in this text, São Paulo is no longer the ultramodern city that must always

[3] Caetano Veloso, "Sampa," track B2 on *Muito (Dentro Da Estrela Azulada)* (Rio de Janeiro: Phonogram/Philips, 1978), vinyl.

[4] B.U.S.H., "Andando pelas ruas," trans. by the band, track A2 on *São Paulo* (Recorded in São Paulo: Rocha Studios, 2007; Published in Germany: Thrashbastard: 2007), Vinyl (lyrics and the band's own translation changed according to the recording and for punctuation, spelling, grammar, and capitalization).

inaugurate trends, where the models are interminably forged to be reproduced elsewhere, and where everyone hopes exclusively to find inspiration. What occurred in São Paulo regarding the struggle for free public transportation is understood in large part also as a consequence of the events that took place in the much smaller city of Florianópolis. To be fair, it is possible to talk about an intellectual and militant partnership between the cities. If one looks for a sole avant-garde, though, it can be difficult to find one. Sometimes it is São Paulo, and other times it is the little capital-island of the state of Santa Catarina that sets the standard to be followed, that provides the example to be admired, that teaches the new truths: if young people are organized and disciplined around a specific claim, such as the free fare, they can, in fact, succeed. They will succeed. Thus, to start the discussion and to introduce the main thesis of this chapter, I must now say: in a similar fashion to the city of Florianópolis, in São Paulo there was also a connection between the hardcore and punk rock scene, the youth-driven protests for free public transportation, and the new digital media outlets at the turn of the twenty-first century.

One of the events that united these three phenomena (music, politics, and the early commercial Internet) was a collective endeavor called Verdurada. The expression "verdurada" can be creatively translated as "vegetable roast" (roast in the sense of a Brazilian barbecue, but without meat, a play on words employed by hardcore straight-edge punks with the Portuguese term *churrascada*).[5] Born as a festival to showcase hardcore music, vegetarianism, and veganism in the 1990s, Verdurada was basically one of the main entities responsible for systematically presenting the discussion about meat avoidance in Brazilian contemporary society.[6] However, its organizers did not restrict themselves only to this subject matter. The event would grow throughout the years and would address a variety of social causes that were incorporated through lectures and debates held alongside the music shows. In 2002, the cultural *and* political event was being defined by the people behind it as follows:

> Verdurada is a bimonthly [event] initially organized by São Paulo's straight-edge community since 1996. There, mostly hardcore bands perform, and the public attends lectures about political issues and participates in workshops, debates, video and art exhibitions with a political or divergent content. In the end, they receive a totally vegetarian dinner included in the price of entry. Within the do-it-yourself spirit that characterizes hardcore punk, the event's organization is totally undertaken by the very hardcore-punk straight-edge community of São Paulo. They are responsible for the contact with bands and speakers, as well as for renting the venue, hiring the sound crews, and promoting the event. The event basically aims at two objectives: to show that it is possible to successfully organize events without the sponsorship of big companies and without paid promotion in the media, and to bring to the public both the music created by the enraged youth and the thoughts and opinions of divergent thinkers and activists. And those objectives have been reached: the regularity of the event and the attending public (around 800 people from Brazil and abroad) confirm that there is a will amongst the youth to realize that they can accomplish what they want, without conforming to the one and only way of thinking that is imposed on them.[7]

[5] Freitas, "Do It Yourcast #45"; *Verdurada: a face sóbria do punk*, dir. Guilherme Frimm, Paulo Henrique Marçaioli, and Rafael Takano (São Paulo: Faculdade Casper Líbero, 2007), video, https://youtu.be/K688paVX6nA.

[6] Calíli Alves Cavalheiro, Fabiane Cortez Verdu, and Juliana Marangoni Amarante, "Difusão do vegetarianismo e veganismo no Brasil a partir de uma perspectiva de transnacionalização," *Revista Eletrônica Ciências da Administração e Turismo*, vol. 6, no. 1 (Jan.–Jul. 2018): 56–57, http://incubadora.periodicos.ifsc.edu.br/index.php/ReCAT/article/view/384.

[7] Coletivo Verdurada, "Release," Verdurada, archived Dec. 12, 2002, https://web.archive.org/web/20021212223346/http://www.verdurada.org/release.htm.

Verdurada is a total experience. The people identifying themselves as straight-edge punks can become engaged in the first planning steps or they may simply participate in the shows as part of the audience. In between those poles, there are debates and announcements of the latest activist news, other forms of artistic expression, the provision of plant-based food, the support of social movements, and the preparation for more political action. The time and place of events are decided taking into account access to the venue through public transportation.[8] Music becomes culture, and it is not restricted only to sound: it incorporates all aspects of life. Verdurada turned out to be so successful in reaching its goals that, beyond international attention, it caught the interest of the repressive state apparatuses. The connections that Verdurada created between hardcore music and activism caused the event to be closely monitored by the police.[9]

Being contemporaneous with the so-called anti-globalization struggles, Verdurada incorporated in its hosted lectures many themes appreciated by the protesters involved in the latter. One of the main participants in the planning of Verdurada was André Mesquita, who today is an art curator. Talking more specifically about the early days of the 2000s, before the emergence of the Free Fare Movement, he explains the relationship between some actors from the beginning of the twenty-first century, actors who would eventually help to pave the way for the creation of a social movement related to public transportation. As discussed earlier, the anti-capitalist protests of the turn of the millennium (closely associated with the birth of São Paulo's Independent Media Center) would later provide important militants to the Free Fare Movement. Verdurada was notably involved in the helping of those early protests:

> This period, this matter about the street protests, about a global call for us to occupy the streets . . . and to make a demonstration against summits, against those transnational organizations, a little of that history passed through Verdurada, because *some folks who were part of the Verdurada Collective were also part of the Independent Media Center* We organized the Verdurada and invited the bands to play and, in the middle of the show, there was a lecture. In that period, I remember us organizing the lectures . . . inviting someone to explain what the anti-globalization movement was, what the anti-capitalist movement is, . . . what Peoples' Global Action is, or what consensus-based decisions are, or to say: "Hey, next week, there will be direct-action training here in some place, . . . how a group has/can behave during a demonstration, . . . how you get organized. . . ." Punk is not actually a monolithic thing, you know, like only to make shows, play music, and get together. No, it indeed had a political purpose . . . of occupying the streets.[10]

Important people behind Verdurada then had links to the collective operation of São Paulo's Independent Media Center. They actually helped in the foundation of a branch of the Independent Media Center in the South American country.[11] The Independent Media Center would be the cybernetic army of the protests against increases in the bus fare that would take Brazil by storm (it was so in Salvador, Florianópolis, and Vitória, and it would be so in São Paulo until at least 2011). The Brazilian version of the website was founded around December 23, 2000: "Everything began with the coverage of the 'Buy Nothing Day,' a demonstration carried out . . . in a shopping mall in the city of Belo Horizonte. At this

[8] *Verdurada*, dir. Frimm, Marçaioli, and Takano; Felipe Madureira, in conversation with the author, January 2022; Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 3 and 125.

[9] See: Vinicius, *Antes de junho*, 253–254.

[10] Mesquita, "Do It Yourcast #09" (my emphasis).

[11] Pereira Fernandes, *Straight edge*, 228; Reia, Straightedge no século XXI, 127–128.

time, [Brazil's] Independent Media Center counted on a few volunteers, and it was only after a protest against the Free Trade Area of the Americas occurred on April 20, 2001, in São Paulo, that the site started to be widely used."[12] As a genuine anti-capitalist project, one of the characteristics of the Independent Media Center is its radical stance against copyright. Its Brazilian chapter was created as a website on which not only could anyone publish, but almost everything that reached life there could also be shared and reproduced openly, as long as it was in a non-commercial way. Its webpages of news and multimedia files very often carried a footer explaining this principle. The note has been present there since the first report written in Portuguese that I was able to retrieve from the Independent Media Center of Brazil's files stored in and crawled by the Internet Archive. The news piece dates from January 3, 2001, and reports on a conflict between punks, an unidentified group of people, the general population, and the repressive police during a show for the celebration of the new year on Paulista Avenue in São Paulo.[13]

It makes sense that the vehicle of news and propaganda of the Free Fare Movement would stand against copyright and had punks (many of them notoriously opposed to copyright laws) as actors in what was perhaps one of its first publications. If people should circulate freely through the urban space to avail themselves of opportunities to learn and grow intellectually, the information must travel unrestrictedly so as to reach more people and change their minds. In December 2002, while hosting a show with three rock bands and one rap group (Os Excluídos [The Excluded], Intifada, Good Intentions, and the hip-hop ensemble Dígito 4 [Digit 4]), Verdurada made sure to include a "Lecture on Copyleft" by scholar and future University of São Paulo professor Pablo Ortellado.[14] Verdurada once more was positioning itself as a space for dissident and subversive ideas: from animal rights to the right of unrestricted transmission of thoughts. In an interview following the massive 2013 protests in Brazil that began in opposition to a bus fare hike in São Paulo, Ortellado is himself defined by the interviewers as a person "with a trajectory of activism *first in the punk movement* and later in the anti-globalization struggles at the turn of the twenty-first century."[15]

There are a number of paths to follow: punks had been part of the fight surrounding the transportation system in São Paulo since its beginning, when the main organization related to this issue was still called Comitê pelo Passe Livre (Committee for the Free Fare). As reported by Oliver Scarcelli: "São Paulo's Committee for the Free Fare for students was established in 2004 with the participation of militants from the Socialist Party of Unified Workers [PSTU], the Workers' Party [PT] (who came from the office of a federal representative at the time, Luiz Eduardo Greenhalgh), punks, and some students from public schools."[16] An intellectual, Ortellado, who had a history within punk culture, was invited by Verdurada to talk about copyleft. The concept, use, and dissemination of copylefted materials were intrinsic to

[12] "FAQ CMI Brasil," Indymedia Documentation Project, archived Feb. 7, 2004, https://web.archive.org/web/20040207121457/http://docs.indymedia.org/view/Local/RedeCMIBrasilFAQ; see also: Santos, *A rebeldia por trás das lentes*, 150–152.

[13] O Coletivo Libertário, "Entrada do 3º milênio na Paulista," *CMI Brasil*, Jan. 3, 2001, https://web.archive.org/web/20140901195859/midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2001/ 01/22.shtml.

[14] Coletivo Verdurada, "Release."

[15] Ortellado, "Pablo Ortellado" (my emphasis).

[16] Scarcelli, "As origens do Movimento Passe Livre," 10 (italics in the original, perhaps owing to "punk" being an English word).

the ideals of the Independent Media Center. The Independent Media Center was the river through which the ideology of the Free Fare Movement would circulate. Verdurada, which is a punk/hardcore music and political festival, was comprised of members who would engage in anti-globalization protests (also one of the embryos of the later Free Fare Movement of São Paulo) and with the Independent Media Center (the de facto media of the struggle for truly universal public transportation). One should note the many connections. It is a true network.

The Independent Media Center

The English version of the Independent Media Center's website first appeared in November 1999 with a bold statement: "The web dramatically alters the balance between multinational and activist media. With just a bit of coding and some cheap equipment, we can set up a live automated website that rivals the corporates. Prepare to be swamped by the tide of activist media makers on the ground in Seattle and around the world." [17] This proclamation, later rescued from oblivion by the work of anthropologist and activist Todd Wolfson, reverberated in the Southern Hemisphere: in Brazil, activists adopted the Independent Media Center as their home. Perhaps no other database of news about political struggles in the country was at the same time so unique and extensive. The militants would no longer be *dependent* on large corporations to tell the story of the social movements, and neither would they be restricted to the physical and political reach of traditional left-wing publications. When an occupation of a building occurred, it would no longer be called an "invasion" without this being denounced as a reactionary journalistic approach and without the activists' perspective being seriously conveyed. Police repression could be denounced. Lies about vandalism and lack of popular support could be refuted. Political events that would never be reported by the conventional press could now be recorded in history.

It is an evident truth that left-wing publications existed long before this, both in Brazil and throughout the world. The novelty of the Independent Media Center, however, is that it could challenge any mainstream newspaper thanks to its instantaneous user-based contributions, its universal reach, and the non-differentiation between activists and reporters. [18] How many newspapers or news agencies could claim in 2004 to have dedicated webpages from about 100 cities (or maybe more), all around the world, with information being fed by thousands of locals in different languages? [19] Anyone with a computer could now become a correspondent. What was being applied there for the creation of media by the anti-capitalist militants was a punk modus operandi. As explained by Leo Vinicius, mediation should be abolished, as the Independent Media Center's "basic idea was of a 'non-mediated media': the

[17] Matthew Arnison and Mansour Jacobi cited in Wolfson, *Digital Rebellion*, 71; original publication: maffew and manse [Matthew Arnison and Mansour Jacobi], "Welcome to indymedia," Seattle Indymedia Center, Nov. 24, 1999, https://web.archive.org/ web/20041102030132/http://seattle.indymedia.org/en/1999/11/2.shtml (I followed the spelling of the original).

[18] About the latter, see: Vinicius, *Antes de junho*, 241 (passage cited further into the text); see also: Santos, *A rebeldia por trás das lentes*, 155.

[19] In an archived page from 2004, the Independent Media Center claimed to be present in "all continents, in more than 90 cities" (Indymedia Documentation Project, "FAQ CMI Brasil"); Carlos André dos Santos claimed the existence of more than 170 collectives belonging to the Independent Media Center around the world until 2008 and exactly 162 in 2004 (Santos, *A rebeldia por trás das lentes*, 107, 132, and 136–137); see also: Wolfson, *Digital Rebellion*, 10, 16, 89 and 115.

protesters themselves become the journalist and editor Do-it-yourself and undo the separation between layperson and expert, producer and consumers."[20]

The principle of non-separation between "producer" and (its apparent opposite) "consumer" is present at every turn in punk practices.[21] The do-it- yourself method is part of the essence of punk, and is linked to the deeper political tendencies of the movement.[22] With the do-it-yourself concept cleverly applied to a digital information channel of social movements, the need for a huge infrastructure to construct a news outlet as powerful as the mass communication conglomerates became relatively unnecessary. This phenomenon of using the Independent Media Center as a means of expression for activists represents a mirror of what had happened within the punk music scene itself. As affirmed in Chapter 1, the fresh ways of recording and disseminating music through mp3s and personal websites transformed the musical genre in Brazil. It ceased to be exclusively or mostly an analog culture and became a hybrid between analog and digital. However, these new possibilities of digital media only fulfilled aspects already present in the good old do-it-yourself utopia, increasingly reducing the necessity of studios, presses, and professional managers for a band to achieve self-sufficiency. Beginning in the late 1970s and early 1980s, punk—through its do-it-yourself attitude—seems to have foreseen forms of organization that only later would reach their pinnacle in the cybernetic revolution of the 1990s. In this sense, what Jacques Attali claims as the task of music in society is confirmed:

> Music is prophecy. Its styles and economic organization are ahead of the rest of society because it explores, much faster than material reality can, the entire range of possibilities in a given code. It makes audible the new world that will gradually become visible, that will impose itself and regulate the order of things; it is not only the image of things, but the transcending of the everyday, the herald of the future. For this reason, musicians, even when officially recognized, are dangerous, disturbing, and subversive; for this reason, it is impossible to separate their history from that of repression and surveillance.[23]

If music is predictive, as claimed by Attali, punk's do-it-yourself ethos, existent since the beginnings of the movement, was a form of hope for other social configurations in a future world. Within that hope was the desire for the emergence of a radical type of media, the media without mediation. Just consider, for example, the self-published zines and albums that are character- istic of punk culture. Then, when the personal computer became financially accessible and the commercial Internet arrived, it is not a coincidence that the new methods for recording and disseminating music were naturally incorporated by punks, even in a peripheral country such as Brazil. There, punks turned out to be the very early users of the Internet, or better, they were among the first to put the Internet to use, learning and propagating ideas ranging from anarchism to vegetarianism, from anti-war thought to revolution, and, of course, about music itself. It is not a coincidence either that the medium without mediation par excellence, the Independent Media Center, was at the same time so closely connected to the punk movement. Cazé, which most likely is the nickname of Carlos André dos Santos, who among other activities studied the Independent Media Center, once

[20] Vinicius, *Antes de junho*, 241.

[21] See: Greene, *Punk and Revolution*, 190; Greene, "On Misanthropology," 42.

[22] See: O'Hara, *The Philosophy of Punk*, 166.

[23] Attali, *Noise*, 11.

left a comment on a website helping celebrate the five years of the Turnstile Revolts: "Most of the folks from the Independent Media Center who I interviewed for my research about the network in Brazil came from the punk and hardcore scene." [24]

However, the Independent Media Center is important not only in terms of the diffusion of socially relevant news. For some time, even the organization of the protests themselves could happen cooperatively through the website, before it became a surveilled space by the repressive state apparatus. In 2007, Rodrigo Ponce declared about the state of things and the brief history of that digital space:

> The Indymedia website or later the Independent Media Center [CMI] in Brazil served to spread news about demonstrations, meetings, *to exchange ideas about how to demonstrate.* It was basically like that in the beginning. After some time, I believe that people stopped organizing themselves so openly on the Independent Media Center, because today there is a lot of surveillance on the website, lots of right-wing attacks, lots of people who could use that information to destroy the demonstrations. Therefore, I believe today that there is a new context that is a challenge to the Indymedia network: to continue to be an independent media center, with an open and democratic publication platform, *which can be used for popular organization and not something turned into a stage for bickering, for reactionary ideas, or a database for repression.* [25]

The militants had to gain the awareness that the Internet could be a tool for the construction of utopia but would not necessarily be a utopian place in itself. [26] The struggle to keep the Independent Media Center out of the hands of the Right exemplifies a type of clash that even the punk culture itself occasionally had to endure. One notorious case is that of Michel Stamatopoulos (known as Sukata) from the band Garotos Podres. After a successful music career, he later became a vocal advocate of far-right politician Jair Bolsonaro. [27] Garotos Podres, created in the 1980s, stands as one of the most influential punk ensembles in Brazil; it was cited, for example, as an inspiration by S288, the Florianópolis hardcore band of the early 2000s that had links to some activities promoted by the militants for the free fare. [28] After the breakup of Garotos Podres because of fundamental political divergences, the band's vocalist, Mao, who continued to be a left-wing militant, went on to form O Satânico Dr. Mao e Os Espiões Secretos (The Satanic Dr. Mao and the Secret Spies). [29] For the release in 2013 of the first version of the song "Repressão Policial (Instrumento do Capital)," meaning "Police Repression (An Instrument of Capitalism)," Mao wrote that the lyrics were initially composed "by way of a simple tribute to these young people from the Free Fare Movement." [30]

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[24] Cazé [probably Carlos André dos Santos], comment to: "5 anos da Revolta da Catraca – o 4º debate," *Passa Palavra*, Jun. 29, 2009, https://passapalavra.info/2009/06/7159/; see, for example: Santos, *A rebeldia por trás das lentes,* 190 and 256; see also: Wolfson, *Digital Rebellion,* 198n20.

[25] Ponce and Takahashi, "Indymedia" (my emphasis).

[26] See: Corrêa, "Balanço crítico acerca da Ação Global dos Povos no Brasil."

[27] Gustavo Fioratti, "Briga de ídolos do punk de SP espelha a polarização política," *Folha de São Paulo*, Aug. 21, 2018, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/ilustrada/2018/08/briga-de-idolos-do-punk-de-sp-espelha-a-polarizacao-politica.shtml.

[28] See: Chapter 2.

[29] Lincoln Secco, "O som de Junho," *Blog da Boitempo*, Oct. 10, 2014, https://blogda- boitempo.com.br/2014/10/10/o-som-de-junho/.

[30] Mao, comment to: Daniel Accioly, "Garotos Podres perde integrante e mudará de nome," *Minuto Música*, May 15, 2013, https://minutomusica.wordpress.com/2013/05/15/garotos-podres-perde-integrante-e-mudara-de-nome/.

In short, Garotos Podres had to be protected from right-wing use by means of a breakup and the later creation of a new band. If punk had to go through such challenges, precautions must have been taken by a website such as the Independent Media Center, which is derived in part from the do-it-yourself philosophy. These precautions would help guard against the media platform being transformed into a conservative or inefficient weapon by appropriation, instability, or surveillance.

This entire account of the Independent Media Center should sound quite similar to the evolution of social media and social networking websites today. These are new instruments that allow a more interactive and egalitarian interaction, a rapid and inexpensive way for the spreading of ideas and events, and the possibility of finding and connecting with like-minded people who would never associate otherwise. In sum, today's social media were a small revolution for leftists and social movements until those same spaces became invaded by state surveillance or were attacked by right-wing thought. The similarities are not a coincidence. According to Manoel Nascimento: "The Independent Media Center was a social media site before social media existed."[31] The Independent Media Center created a space in which it was possible to network with others and to discover, share, and comment on non-mainstream information. It is not only a question of simple anticipation of a historical phenomenon; the social media of today might actually have their origins in the Independent Media Center. Such a website, created in opposition to the status quo and heavily influenced by radical ideas, most likely provoked a real worldwide transformation in the possibilities of communication. Its principles subverted, reverberated, and infiltrated other areas of the digital human enterprise. Ortellado is one of those who believes that the new anti-capitalist movements that emerged in the late 1990s and early 2000s had a significant and decisive influence on the development of the contemporary Internet:

> The inventor of the concept of the blog was the Independent Media Center. There were no blogs. People did not do that. They created sites. The idea of a blog, something that is easy to write on and capable of being updated quickly, did not exist. The Independent Media Center is a pre-blog thing, pre-creative commons. And it is not by chance that many of the social network companies were developed from the Independent Media Center: Twitter, YouTube, Flickr, and Craigslist This also has to do with the form of organization belonging to the US liberal left that allows passages from social movements to the market in a way that we [Brazilians] would consider bizarre—but in the US context it is not. . . . However, this is a hidden history: this history was never told because the actors are ashamed. I know several of them. They are ashamed because they are people who are still militants today. The same way I went into academia, they went to work for companies. . . . But it is important to exemplify this issue to make clear that we are not copying the networks, but, in fact, they copied us.[32]

It is still not possible to trace those connections pointed out by Ortellado without hearing the personal accounts of engineers and programmers involved in the early years of enterprises such as Twitter or YouTube. Hopefully, one day that information will be gathered and reported in detail. What we can trace, however, is that 1999 was indeed a watershed year in the digital realm concerning the creation of new tools for collaborative communication and

[31] Nascimento, in conversation with the author, August 2020; see also: Nascimento, "A 'geração Seattle' e a 'geração de acampantes.'"

[32] Ortellado, "Pablo Ortellado"; see also: Oliveira, "Entrevista com o Movimento Passe Livre"; and: Wolfson, *Digital Rebellion*, 77 (Wolfson, by citing Dorothy Kidd, reinforces a kind of opposite or complementary story, of how employees of already existent tech companies helped in the creation of the Independent Media Center).

the sharing of information. By about February 1999—the year in which the first post went online on the English-version website of the Independent Media Center—it was believed that only 23 blogs operated on the web, as reiterated in an article by Cameron Chapman: "By the middle of 2006, there were 50 million blogs according to Technorati's State of the Blogosphere report."[33] The word "blog" was coined in the first half of 1999, and the platform Blogger was initially made available in August of that year.[34]

Although it marginally followed the creation of blog platforms such as Groksoup, Pitas, and Blogger, the innovation of the Independent Media Center a few months later seemed to offer more than the possibility of getting a new web address or using an existent one and "updat[ing] [it] frequently with chronologically sorted posts . . . by submitting a form on . . . [a] web site," as explained by Blogger at the end of the twentieth century.[35] The produced material made public through Blogger was still fragmented across several digital locations and was difficult to compile, especially in those early days of modern Internet search engines. The Independent Media Center, whose use in Brazil was propelled by the anti-capitalist protests in São Paulo, consisted of a collective and open endeavor in which anyone could not only comment on the work of others but also create their own posts without the need for establishing their own web address. In sum, it connected the best of two worlds as a true social media platform. All news would be easily concentrated in one place while at the same time being generated in a decentralized fashion. Another militant from the anti-capitalist generation of the turn of the century, Felipe Corrêa, follows a similar line of thought, linking the tools of the Internet of the 2010s with the innovations caused by the Independent Media Center in 1999.

> What history shows . . . is that the tools of the Web, which today are called 2.0, were, to a great extent, a creation of this movement of the new global Left. [They were] decentralized technologies, which allowed participation, collective construction, within the spirit that characterized the movement itself. . . . Some members of the Global Independent Media Center [Network] became, for example, central members within the project of the development of Twitter. The example of the Independent Media Center of an open comments section was followed by the majority of web portals belonging to corporate media.[36]

Punks, with their do-it-yourself principle, had previously used the Xerox machine to circumvent the printing industry before the rise and popularization of the Internet.[37] At that time, the need for mediation was already beginning to be eliminated. With access to photocopiers becoming increasingly common all over the world, news and other informa-

[33] Cameron Chapman, "A Brief History of Blogging," Webdesigner Depot (WDD), Mar. 14, 2011, https://www.webdesignerdepot.com/2011/03/a-brief-history-of-blogging/; see also: Rebecca Blood, "Weblogs: A History and Perspective," Rebecca's Pocket, Sep. 7, 2000, https://smg.media.mit.edu/library/blood2000.html.

[34] Chapman, "A Brief History of Blogging"; Peter Merholz, "Play with Your Words," Peterme.com, May 17, 2002, https://www.peterme.com/archives/00000205.html; "Camworld," Camworld, Feb. 7, 1999, https://web.archive.org/web/19990208011955/http://www.camworld.com:80/.

[35] "Blogger," Blogger, archived Oct. 12, 1999, https://web.archive.org/web/19991012022531/http://blogger.com/ cited in Amanda Zantal-Wiener, "A Brief Timeline of the History of Blogging," HubSpot, Sep. 13, 2016, https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/history-of-blogging; see also: Scott Rosenberg, *Say Everything: How Blogging Began, What It's Becoming, and Why It Matters* (New York: Crown Publishers: 2009), 113; Blood, "Weblogs"; Chapman, "A Brief History of Blogging."

[36] Corrêa, "Balanço crítico acerca da Ação Global dos Povos no Brasil."

[37] Greene, *Punk and Revolution*, 18–19 and 175.

tion about the movement and its ideology could be spread within each national context, and perhaps even international exchanges could emerge. No doubt it was an effective method, but it carried its own limitations. Monetary constraints could play a role. The distribution system for physical copies of a text or image required shipping or face-to-face sales. The very number of copies was, obviously, finite, and the networks of contact could be restricted to small circles. With the Internet, however, a radical new model of communication served punks and activists so that they could step up to a different level. They were finally a decent match for the heavy hitters in terms of reach. Now, many of those limits were instantaneously removed. Ironically, however, it was the music industry that orchestrated one of the largest attacks on Internet freedom with its anti-piracy campaigns.[38] Music dominated by capitalist interests served as the perfect excuse to regulate what people could do with the new sound, visual, and textual media types. Faced with a loss of power, the large entertainment companies attempted to act as steamrollers to squash less-conforming users of cyberspace. This led to the de facto elimination of many websites and application software. Reebee Garofalo wrote in 2003 in this regard:

> The music industry has been trying to convince consumers that there is a monster in their computers: the monster of copyright violation. It has gone variously by the name of MP3, Napster, Gnutella, Freenet, Scour, and LimeWire, and already there are others such as Morpheus and KaZaA. These technologies are part of a digital revolution that is transforming the way music is produced and consumed. The music industry is terrified that computer users sharing and downloading music tracks for free over the Internet will seriously cut into sales of compact discs, still the centerpiece of the industry's business model. In their attempts to curtail this development, the industry has adopted a two-pronged strategy of legislation and litigation, advocating for laws that extend the reach of copyright and filing lawsuits against alleged copyright infringers While Napster was subsequently crushed under the weight of music industry litigation, newer technologies such as Gnutella and Freenet and second-generation services such as Morpheus and KaZaA have taken the process further.[39]

However, as corporations in developed countries began lobbying for harsher copyright laws and resorting to aggressive legal measures, opposition to these tactics emerged as well. Many people believed that the new possibilities of the digital era should be defended, and dissent emerged even on the margins of Western capitalism. Punk resistance in Brazil was not only musical but also political. The assault on "piracy" produced a do-it-yourself response among both militants and musicians, which was (the encouragement to) the use of open-source software and free downloadable cultural artifacts. It was in 2002 that São Paulo's hardcore music festival, Verdurada, would, for example, organize the debate on copyleft featuring guest speaker Ortellado. In 2006, Belo Horizonte's hardcore and punk political event, Carnaval Revolução, would include the dissemination of free open-source software as part of its activities.[40] Additionally, it is wise to remember that most of the work published on the Independent Media Center website was instantly labeled copyright-free.

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[38] In terms of the leap forward that the Internet represented for underground musicians and members of the scene and the reactionary stance adopted by the music industry, see: Reia, *Straightedge no século* XXI, 47–48, 119–122, and 129.

[39] Reebee Garofalo, "I Want My MP3: Who Owns Internet Music?" in *Policing Pop*, ed. Martin Cloonan and Reebee Garofalo (Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 2003), 30 and 31, https://www.jstor.org/stable/j.ctt14bsz5b.6 (changed for capitalization).

[40] See: Chapter 4.

The punk do-it-yourself attitude was then the perfect match for movements such as the Independent Media Center or Verdurada that wanted to make the enforcement of copyrights less constraining. Additionally, freeing oneself of copyright restrictions would fit nicely with those who wanted a *free* public transportation system as well. Propelled by the new possibilities of the digital era, a growing open-source, copyleft, and free culture could connect itself with the principle that people should develop, create, and *circulate* what and where they desire without the need for resources unattainable by the non-rich individual, isolated citizens, or non-professional groups. With copyleft, not only could one do it by oneself, one could also build upon the work of others with very few restrictions and without the fear of being targeted by a lawsuit of some kind. Better still, the resulting derivative work would have to be placed in the same chain of freedom for others to use and, perhaps, to improve upon, again and again. In the end, copyleft and free public transportation are both about autonomy of movement.

Vegetarianism and the Struggle for the Free Fare

The new wave of members of the broad punk culture in Brazil in the 1990s and 2000s—more specifically, those who designated themselves as being straight edge—had a composition somewhat different from that of the early days of the punk movement in São Paulo.

The older punk culture from the late 1970s and the 1980s was characterized as originating from the poor outskirts of Brazil's largest urban area. It is a startling paradox: the tropical version of an international avant-garde phenomenon was born in the highly underprivileged regions of São Paulo, among the renegades of a city with profound misery that, at the same time, stood as an industrial leader of the Western Hemisphere.[41] Those early punks became globally known for a 1982 festival titled O Começo do Fim do Mundo (The Beginning of the End of the World). The event was described as a moment of "utopia" by Pádua, a member of the punk band Passeatas (Marches), thanks to its do-it-yourself ethos and its objective of sowing peace among several rival factions.[42] A radical leftist inclination was already being openly displayed at the festival. One of the performing bands, Inocentes, remarked from the stage: "I want to see you practicing anarchy. Long live the working class. Long live the proletarian class. Long live punks!"[43] The festival also embraced the repudiation of a decaying military dictatorship. For the participants, the termination of the world should mark the birth of a new one, characterized by the hope for less repression and more freedom, as one can understand from the following description: "The festival . . . blows up punk culture in everyone's face in the midst of an authoritarian government."[44] Linking this last sentence with the war cry of Inocentes, it is possible to say that such a rejection of the military dictatorship of that epoch had the intense characteristic of being undertaken by those at the bottom of the social stratification.

[41] Bivar, *Punk*, 102.

[42] *Botinada*, dir. Gastão Moreira.

[43] *Inocentes – 30 anos*, dir. Carol Thomé and Duca Mendes, trans. uncredited (São Paulo: 6:01 Audiovisual, 2011), video, https://youtu.be/jSUfZE5SioE (translation changed for capitalization).

[44] *O fim do mundo, enfim: o documentário*, dir. Camila Miranda, trans. uncredited (São Paulo: SESC, 2016), DVD (translation corrected for spelling).

Some of São Paulo's younger straight-edge individuals, some of whom were involved with the Verdurada Collective in the 1990s and 2000s, originated from more economically stable homes within the wealth pyramid and from a more formally democratic state. Mesquita, for example, confirmed in an interview that he is an inhabitant of a "middle-class neighborhood" and not the "outskirts" of the metropolis.[45] Frederico Freitas also comes from the central neighborhoods of São Paulo.[46] Freedom of expression, in its turn, was relatively higher in the 1990s as well, when Verdurada was established. In general, straight-edge individuals listen to hardcore-punk music but also are known for abstaining from using drugs, alcohol, and tobacco, and many of them are vegetarian or vegan.[47] They believe that the human organism and its mind must be kept clean from external harmful agents; they also seek to stop the destruction of other bodies and to refuse the ingestion of any food considered unethical. However, not all of those new punks were from the middle class, even though this seemed to be the case in a higher proportion than was found in the 1980s. Moreover, straight-edge vegetarianism and anti-drug attitude are in opposition to the social inequalities of peripheral capitalism:

> In Brazil, we were tired of seeing people from the outskirts trying to be playboys by sniffing poor-quality cocaine. Capitalism drugged itself. Should we do the same? We wanted to shock, and we shocked. We ended up being disliked by all groups: punks, non-punks, headbangers, skateboarders, junkies. Fuck them. In order to avoid annoying comments and to escape from punk gangs, we started to organize our own shows in alternative venues . . . [like] cultural centers, libraries, and even in unimaginable places such as beauty salons. These activities culminated with the creation of Verdurada, which ended up gathering more than 1,000 people in Jabaquara starting in 1996, but it had also taken place before that (1993–1994) in Guarulhos and Grajaú (in the southern zone of São Paulo).[48]

Based on these words delivered by Kiko Dinucci, it appears that the rejection of drug use by the Brazilian straight-edge punks also represented a denunciation of a society in which narcotics were linked to a life of productivity at all costs. Worse, it could be a form of alienation and fundamental inaction in the face of an alarming sociopolitical situation. This stance made straight edge a well-defined and particular subgroup within punk culture, which led them to develop their own means of expression and circulation of ideas. Verdurada was the culmination of this process. As a result of the group's opposition to alcohol and other drugs, straight-edge events and shows in Brazil are known for explicitly prohibiting the consumption of those substances inside their venues. Within a culture that praises freedom, these are behaviors that remain expressly forbidden. Such a thing led to criticism of the straight-edge community as being a conservative and even religious-like manifestation derived from (and with the aim of purifying) punk culture.[49] However, Freitas argues that "the straight edge that I tried to do, that I tried to create through Verdurada and through my band [Point of No Return] was a leftist, emancipatory, progressist, and critical political thing. . . . It was not conservative, far from that."[50] In fact, the alcohol and drug avoidance can sometimes represent

[45] Mesquita, "Do It Yourcast #09."

[46] Frederico Freitas, in conversation with the author, January 2022.

[47] Gabriel Kuhn, ed., *Sober Living for the Revolution: Hardcore Punk, Straight Edge, and Radical Politics* (Oakland: PM Press, 2010), 13.

[48] Kiko Dinucci, "Posfácio: o punk e a sua eterna reinvenção," in *Punk*, Antonio Bivar (São Paulo: Edições Barbatana, 2018), 129.

[49] Pereira Fernandes, *Straight edge*, 105–106, 263, 266, and 268.

[50] Frederico Freitas, in conversation with the author, January 2022.

an anti-establishment stance.[51] In Brazil, where the promotion of alcohol is widespread and its intake is positively depicted on television (commercials are heavily based on the figure of the *macho*), the straight-edge attitude can be seen as embodying a sign of nonconformism and a critical posture. São Paulo's band Discarga recorded in 2008 "Teor alcoólico" ("Alcohol by Volume"), in which the ensemble denounces the damage caused by excessive drinking. In the first line of the lyrics, they refer to an advertising slogan for the beer brand Skol, which repeatedly states that its product is "the beer that goes down smooth," but Discarga changed the word "beer" to "sentence." They walked away from the advertisement to arrive at punk music.

A sentença que desce redondo	*The sentence that goes down smooth*
Embriaguez é a ruína da razão	*Drunkenness is the ruin of reason*
É uma velhice prematura	*It's a premature old age*
Uma morte temporária	*A temporary death*
Jogando sujo à moda capitalista	*Playing dirty the capitalist way*
Diversão, alucinação e alienação	*Fun, hallucination, and alienation*
Vício degradante e humilhante	*Humiliating and degrading addiction*
Social, prático e legal	*A social, practical, and legal one*
Uma velhice prematura	*A premature old age*
Uma morte temporária	*A temporary death*
Deturpação de ideias	*Perversion of ideas*
Ideias deturpadas	*Perverted ideas*[52]

In addition to their class composition, condemnation of alcohol and drug use, and veganism and vegetarianism, a significant number of members of the straight-edge scene in São Paulo can be defined as White, especially more toward the beginning of the scene in the mid-1990s.[53] This is especially so if one considers Brazil's skin-color pigmentocracy and compares the composition of straight edge to other insubordinate youth cultures such as Brazilian hip-hop. It is also significant that, for a former member of the São Paulo straight-edge band Point of No Return, Frederico Freitas, the predominance of "aesthetic whiteness" was an issue that would deserve more attention from the scene.[54] In a 2008 interview, Róbson Véio, the vocalist of the band Lumpen from Salvador, where the hardcore scene included many more people of color, voiced hope after seeing more Blacks in the shows of São Paulo. His statement could mean that, several years before 2008, the shows were actually predominantly White: "For me, hardcore was always a community, and I thought it was becoming lost. Today, I am glad because there are many more Black people [in the shows in São Paulo] Because hardcore was always a street thing. And, for me, a straight-edge individual is a punk

[51] Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 90.

[52] Discarga, "Teor Alcoólico," track 4 on *Música pra guerra*, recorded 2008, https://lajarex.bandcamp.com/album/m-sica-pra-guerra (lyrics changed according to the recording).

[53] According to Walisson Pereira Fernandes: "In a video of the first Verdurada [in 1996], of the show by the band Self Conviction (with the song 'Something to Stay'), one sees a crowd of people with short hair, colorful clothes, most of them white, listening to a band that sings its songs in English" (Pereira Fernandes, Straight edge, 178) (my emphasis); a predominantly White majority also seems to a characteristic of the Independent Media Center (and predecessors), at least in its US incarnation. See: Wolfson, *Digital Rebellion*, 8, 12, 22, 49, 70, 172 and 190.

[54] Freitas, "Interview with Frederico Freitas," 94.

who doesn't drink."[55] This statement is in tune with another argument by Freitas that, toward the 2000s, more people of color joined the scene.[56] Anyhow, Brazil might not have always differed from other countries in the same Western hemisphere, where the participants of the hardcore culture were primarily young White men.[57] However, one needs to consider that many times, as posited by Stephen Duncombe and Maxwell Tremblay, these White young men precisely turned to punk as an "outsider identity" and even as a way "to reject one's inherited whiteness," which, on the one hand, is a positive instance that weakens racism and, on the other hand, can have paradoxical implications such as the non-acknowledgement of deeper racial issues within the scene.[58]

Even though there are characteristics that make straight edge a particular and relatively newer group within the punk scene in Brazil, the straight-edge individuals sought to learn either from the early punks or from other divisions of punk. This is illustrated not only by inviting older bands to perform at the shows, but also by the person selected to speak and teach them about copyleft at the 2002 Verdurada—the activist Ortellado.[59] Here, a connection between generations or at least between different branches of punk is established. To quote Ortellado himself, there was that first generation of Brazilian punks who emerged "in the late 1970s, which we called the 'Generation '82.'"[60] In the early 1980s and until at least the mid-1990s in São Paulo, a considerable number of members of incarnations of the punk movement worked as "office boys," doing outside errands for companies and businesses.[61] Their habitat was, in fact, the streets of the metropolis, and they belonged to the proletariat of the country's financial center. Ortellado's own generation came along a bit later after Generation '82. Still with a strong presence of office boys, it was made up of:

> Punks who got politicized in the very late 1980s. It must be the second or third generation. . . . It was the generation that met the unions. In 1987 and 1988, we tried organizing the office boys' union (I was an office boy) together with a process of refoundation of the Brazilian Workers' Confederation [Confederação Operária Brasileira], which was the 1910s Anarchist Workers' Confederation.[62]

In the 1990s and 2000s punk movement, there was important engagement with left-wing politics as well, with bands espousing various positions within the progressive political spectrum. The movement extended beyond anarchist tendencies (some ensembles were composed of Marxists) and found itself to be distinctively global, with the Brazilian scene in dialog with the scenes from other countries. Maikon Duarte, even though not living specifically in São Paulo but in Joinville, stated in an interview a sentiment that can now serve to explain a general tendency of the straight-edge community in Brazil concerning its international connections: "The hardcore and punk bands from the Netherlands, particularly the straight-edge bands (we

[55] Lumpen, "Entrevista – Lumpen."

[56] Frederico Freitas, in conversation with the author, January 2022.

[57] Kuhn, *Sober Living for the Revolution*, 2010; gender disparity was, for example, rampant in the Brazilian straight scene of the mid-1990s and continued until the 2010s (Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 126 and 158).

[58] Duncombe and Tremblay, "White Riot?," 3–4 and 9.

[59] Restos de Nada, for example, is a historical punk band that would be approached to play at Verdurada in 2012 (Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 136 and 176).

[60] Ortellado, "Pablo Ortellado."

[61] *Botinada*, dir. Gastão Moreira; *Punks*, dir. Yakhni and Gieco; Gomes dos Santos, *Vivo na cidade*, 55; Lopes de Sousa, *Punk*, 56–57.

[62] Ortellado, "Pablo Ortellado."

even called them 'red edge'), which were openly communists (Manliftingbanner, Mainstrike, Feeding The Fire, Seein' Red, DeadStoolPigeon) . . . [were important for] the punk, hardcore folks, who had a more political, left-wing attitude, who understood themselves as leftists."[63]

Left-wing politics strongly connected to animal rights defines much of the straight-edge punk community. As explained by Craig O'Hara: "A rational look at the wasted resources, health issues, and the acceptance of a deeper or more humane ecology has caused a growing number of punks to become vegetarians The punk philosophy tends to believe that the exploitation of animals is another step towards allowing the exploitation of people."[64] The oppression of humans by capitalism runs parallel to the relationships between humans and nature as well as humans and other animals, which are seen as slaves to the insatiable desire for profit. Discarga once more addressed a favorite theme of the straight-edge community with a 2003 song called "Sempre ganância" ("Always Greed"), in which those aspects linking the oppression of men and women to animal subjugation are condensed:

Mais um pescoço degolado	*Another decapitated being*
Outra refeição é servida	*Another meal is served*
Mais um cérebro perfurado	*Another pierced brain*
Outra pesquisa concebida	*Another research is conceived*
Exploração humana e animal	*Human and animal exploitation*
Para servir uma podre ganância	*In order to serve a rotten greed*
O funil ao contrário do capitalismo	*Capitalism's inverted funnel*
Mata, desperdiça, contamina	*It kills, wastes, contaminates*
Poluindo águas, desmatando florestas	*Polluting waters, deforesting woodlands*
Injetando venenos, não há ética	*Injecting poisons, there is no ethics*
Isso tenta se esconder	*They try to hide it*
Mas meus olhos tudo podem ver	*But my eyes can see everything*[65]

In the song, animals lose their lives through vicious exploitation, and the natural environment is ruined as well. Both the destruction of animals and of the environment are perhaps a consequence of the domination of one human being by another. The hardcore-punk singer acts as the one responsible for unveiling the situation; he stands inevitably conscious of it. Moreover, abstention from eating meat and using animal-based products represents a stance against industrialization. The factory-like raising of living creatures is attacked, as these creatures are restricted only to production and reproduction. Here, one can see another remarkable equivalence with the struggle for free public transportation for students. In the same way in which it is unacceptable to reduce animals' lives only to production, one cannot tolerate the lives of young people being restricted only to school (the preparatory institution for youths to enter the productive system). The liberation of animals becomes linked with the liberation of students, and a connection can be traced between animal rights and the right to free and unrestrained mobility. Young people must release themselves from the cage of education as

[63] Maikon Duarte, in conversation with the author, July 2020.

[64] O'Hara, *The Philosophy of Punk*, 132 and 137.

[65] Discarga, "Sempre ganância," track 9 on *Sem remorso,* recorded 2003, https://lajarex.bandcamp.com/album/sem-remorso; Discarga, "Sempre ganância," Letras, accessed Jul. 8, 2020, https://www.letras.mus.br/discarga/689186/ (lyrics changed according to the recording and for punctuation and capitalization).

their only allowed activity. They should be able to circulate through cultural spaces or even roam the city to ensure that they can understand and appreciate different realities. Bicycles appear to be a first alternative, but, ultimately, buses are the mode of transportation that enables broad circulation and roaming. Universal access to public transportation becomes the other side of a coin that has as one of its faces the fight for vegetarianism and veganism.

It is not a coincidence that, as early as 2003, a Verdurada event offered a reduction in the entrance ticket price for those arriving by bike and, hence, using an alternative, less-polluting, and more democratic means of transportation.[66] The appeal of bicycles remained strong for some of those hardcore, straight-edge punks. In November 2005, another Verdurada hosted shows featuring the bands Periferia S/A, ROT, Polara, Julgamento (Judgment), and Busscops. Together with the performances, they prepared the screening of the film *Sociedade do automóvel* (*Automobile Society)*, whose exhibition had the support of those who had participated in São Paulo's Critical Mass cycling event (Bicicletada).[67] However, nothing compares to what had happened in July of that year, 2005, when the 13th São Paulo Hardcore Festival included a discussion about nothing less than "the free fare struggle."

That São Paulo Hardcore Festival was organized by the Verdurada Collective, obviously following the ideas of the straight-edge community. It completely forbade tobacco and alcoholic beverages, and a "free vegetarian/ vegan dinner [was served] at the end of the event." According to an announcement promoting the activities, both the bands Discarga and B.U.S.H., which later would change its name to Futuro (Future), performed at the festival.[68] They shared the stage with other ensembles: Violator, D.E.R., Deeper Than That, Besta-Fera (Bestial Beast), Morte Asceta (Ascetic Death), Lobotomia (Lobotomy), Are You God?, and Thee Butchers' Orchestra. The poster bears the names of the bands, the strict rules about intoxicating substances, and information regarding the lecture on free public transportation and the free vegan food to be served at the conclusion of the activities. Additionally, it bears a drawing loosely divided into three sections. Below, there is a wall of policemen whose helmets are typical of anti-riot forces; they stand ready for repression. In the middle, the design depicts empty buses, most likely representing the ones stopped by protesters during a revolt against a fare increase. Above, young militants represent the celebration of victory. Flames in the background hint at the dimension of the conflict (Fig. 5.1)

[66] Coletivo Verdurada, "verdurada.novembro.2003," Flickr, Sep. 13, 2008, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/2853504631/in/album-72157607271244226/.

[67] Busscops, "Classic – Shows (7 of 91)," Myspace, accessed May 25, 2022, https://myspace.com/busscops/mixes/classic-shows-363753/photo/89306525; Coletivo Verdurada, "verdurada.novembro.2005," Flickr, Sep. 16, 2008, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/2864530688/in/album-72157607271244226/; "Verdurada," Last.fm, Nov. 13, 2005, https://www.last.fm/festival/57575+Verdurada; *Sociedade do Automóvel*, dir. Branca Nunes and Thiago Benicchio (São Paulo: 2005), video, https://youtu.be/4eWvSwzkidE.

[68] About the change of name from B.U.S.H. to Futuro, see: Eric Phipps, "São Paulo Punks Futuro," *Impose*, n.d., https://imposemagazine.com/bytes/new-music/so-paulo-punks-futuro; and: Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 182.



Fig. 5.1: Coletivo Verdurada (Design by Felipe Madureira), 13th São Paulo Hardcore Festival, July 2005. CC BY-NC-ND 2.0.[69] The São Paulo hardcore event took place just two and half weeks after the end of Florianópolis' Second Turnstile Revolt. As stated by André Mesquita, in the posters for Verdurada: "We always thought about placing some image making reference to a case of our interest."[70]

Felipe Madureira, who authored this specific poster, also stated: "We knew that much repression was going on [in Florianópolis] . . . and we were kind of in solidarity with the people who went through that. . . In this poster, there are the little buses from Sex Pistols The police are there defending private interests. Transportation, although part of it [being] public, much of it is controlled by the private sector. And we know that police protect capital." 71 Madureira is referring to the buses from Jamie Reid's design for Sex Pistols' single "Pretty Vacant." One of the most telling things about the Brazilian version is that the buses in the Sex Pistols' poster come displaying the words "nowhere" and "boredom," which were apparently substituted for "holiday" by Madureira.

The link between the Verdurada hardcore-punk event and the discussion about the democratization of transportation within the city were further strengthened throughout the

[69] Coletivo Verdurada, "festival.julho.2005," Flickr, Sep. 13, 2008, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/2853505047/.

[70] Mesquita, "Do It Yourcast #09."

[71] Felipe Madureira, in conversation with the author, January 2022.

years. According to Lucas "Legume" Oliveira, the Free Fare Movement took advantage of the shows to sell its politically oriented merchandise and even sometimes received monetary help from the Verdurada Collective.[72] As another example, at the end of January 2011, the same Verdurada Collective organized the two-day 18th São Paulo Hardcore Festival. In between the shows, there was a lecture by Pedalinas, a feminist collective engaged in making it possible for female bicyclists to pedal more safely around the city. Pedalinas shared the stage with the bands Violator, Sweet Suburbia, Jah-Hell Kick, Western Day, Homem Elefante, Confronto, Futuro, Final Round, and Against All My Friends (from Chile).[73] The anti-capitalist discourse was, undoubtedly, present throughout the performances; one has simply to look for it in the compositions of an ensemble such as Confronto. They came from Rio de Janeiro with works such as "Guerra, queda e morte" ("War, Fall, and Death"). Released as part of their 2001 album *A Insurreição (The Insurrection)*, it features a screaming voice that demands: "War against property / Down with the state / Death to the followers."[74] However, it was a thrash metal band, Violator, from the city of Brasília that had recorded a piece of extreme significance to the struggle against cars as the privileged means of transportation in the early twenty-first century. In their repertoire, there is a work called "Apocalypse Engine." Sung in English and released in 2010, its lyrics were inspired by the book Apocalipse Motorizado, the compendium of anti-car texts translated into Portuguese by one of the key figures of Florianópolis' Turnstile Revolts, Leo Vinicius:

Machine Tyranny

Anxiety for freedom

Ignoring other's pain

Becoming another prison.

Smashing. Pollution damage growing up so high.

Mass graves so that few have the privilege to oppress more.

Blood for oil

Supporting their war.

The crisis won't be felt

Inside the armored box.

[72] Lucas Oliveira (Legume), in conversation with the author, January 2022.

[73] Coletivo Verdurada, "festival.janeiro.2011," Flickr, Dec. 22, 2010, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/5325217349/in/album-72157607271244226/; Ribeiro, "A história oral da Bicicletada em SP"; "Pedalinas ajuda mulheres que querem andar de bike," *Catraca Livre*, Sep. 28, 2011, https://catracalivre.com.br/saude-bem-estar/coletivopedalinas-incentiva-e-ajuda-mulheres-que-querem-andar-de-bike/; "Pedalinas marcam presença na Verdurada!" *Pedalinas*, Feb. 5, 2011, https://pedalinas.wordpress.com/2011/02/05/pedalinas-marcam-presenca-na-verdurada.

[74] "Guerra à propriedade / Queda ao Estado / Morte aos seguidores" (Confronto, "Guerra, Queda e Morte," track 1 on *A Insurreição*, recorded 2001, mp3, https://confronto.bandcamp.com/album/a-insurrei-o; "Confronto," Deck, accessed Jun. 20, 2020, http://deckdisc.com.br/confronto/).

Smashing. Pollution damage growing up so high.

Mass graves so that few have the privilege to oppress more.

Feel the signs of rot

The Apocalypse Engine

Fuel for the end of times

The Apocalypse Engine

Will come the day, [and] it's not so far,

that the smoke will erase [us] from our mind

Lungs as black stop the pulse

until then, let the engines make noise!

Apocalypse! Engine!

Apocalypse! Engine!

Your thirst for speed,

Consents destruction

Use your belt,

In the rape of our land!

Feel the signs of rot

The Apocalypse Engine

Fuel for the end of times

The Apocalypse Engine[75]

In Violator's song "Apocalypse Engine," the car is the destroyer of the environment and not a synonym for human emancipation. It will bring the end of the world through contamination of the Earth and the wars provoked by the interests of the fuel industry. The dark sound of the electric guitar and its slow tempo during the introductory chords helps to create the

[75] Violator, "Apocalypse Engine," track 4 on Annihilation Process, recorded 2009, released 2010, mp3, https://violatorthrash.bandcamp.com/album/annihilation-process (lyrics changed for spelling and according to the record); Adriana Farias, "Com ingressos esgotados, banda Violator fará último show em SP," Veja São Paulo, Jan. 19, 2018, https://vejasp.abril.com.br/blog/musica/violator-ultimo-show-sp/.

atmosphere of catastrophe. The delay effect applied on the voice of the singer in the last word of the first and third lines of the fifth and ninth stanzas complements the prophetic nature of the song. According to Attali: "The musician, like music, is ambiguous. He plays a double game. He is simultaneously *musicus* and *cantor*, reproducer and prophet. If an outcast, he sees society in a political light. If accepted, he is its historian, the reflection of its deepest values. He speaks of society and he speaks against it."[76] Violator, a band recognized as important by Verdurada, acts as a radical historian registering the chaotic state of the human habitat as a result of our selection of the automobile as our primary means of transportation. The band also registers the new thought emerging in Brazil at the time (the song is derived from a radical, left-wing book): a growing opposition to the current condition of urban spaces where the metropolises are constructed to grant privileges to the circulation of cars. At the same time, the members of Violator are outsiders, performing thrash metal in English in a country like Brazil. Prophetically and politically, they announce that civilization will most likely collapse if it continues to follow the same path.

After January's event with the women cycling collective Pedalinas and the band Violator, another Verdurada was organized in June 2011. This time, the Free Fare Movement occupied the position of special guest, and a discussion led by Lúcio Gregori about the movement's activities enjoyed a central place.[77] A punk who attended the activities wrote the following about that day:

> The folks from the Free Fare Movement take the stage in order to conduct a very cool lecture about the struggle against the hikes of the fare and the new combat flag of the movement: mobilization for the zero fare I became very happy to know that that small spark from an ending bonfire was not an unsuccessful story of a one-day wonder, but rather the beginning of a great flame of struggles, which each person must ignite within oneself and must call upon oneself the responsibility of asserting the dissatisfaction against this rotten transportation system, totally dominated by mafia-like businessmen. The zero fare is based on the following plausible argument: if public schools and hospitals are free, why not transportation, too? The reason why one should join that struggle was thoroughly explained. [I was] amazed at the lecture and the public's attention, which asked some talkative people to shut up so that they did not disturb.[78]

The engineer Gregori, then in his 70s, was rediscovered by the young militants as a person who, two decades earlier, had attempted to implement a groundbreaking project in São Paulo regarding urban mobility, demonstrating that the struggle for free public transportation in Brazil was a long one. It stood there, before and after the Turnstile Revolts of Florianópolis. Its modern institutional consequences could be traced back to Gregori's plan for a universal zero fare when Luiza Erundina from the Workers' Party, as the mayor of São Paulo (1989–1992), selected Gregori to head the transportation division of the city's government: the universal zero fare was, in fact, partly applied in a sector of the metropolis.[79] By reading the work of

[76] Attali, *Noise*, 12.

[77] Coletivo Verdurada, "Release: Verdurada de junho," *Altsongs*, May 10, 2011, http://altsongs.blogspot.com/2011/05/release-verdurada-de-junho.html.

[78] Fernando Feio, "Verdurada – 05/06/2011 – Ego Club, centro de São Paulo," *Cena Punk SP, Jun. 13, 2011,* http://cenapunksp.blogspot.com/2011/06/verdurada-05062011-ego-club-centro-de.html (some words changed for capitalization); of course, the lectures at Verdurada had no unanimous attendance, as some people were more interested in music than in politics (see: *Verdurada*, dir. Frimm, Marçaioli, and Takano); for a general description of the environment during a lecture at Verdurada, see: Reia, *Straightedge no século XXI*, 185–188.

[79] Bispo and Frighetto, "Movimento Passe Livre nasceu em Florianópolis e tomou o Brasil."

Vinicius, one can say that the rediscovery of Gregori occurred when this historical precedent was learned by the Free Fare Movement: "The evolution of the Free Fare Movement's banner, from the student free fare to the universal free fare (the zero fare), started already in 2005, the year in which they found out about the proposal and the experience that occurred in 1990 in São Paulo."[80] In that Verdurada, together with the Free Fare Movement discussion led by Gregori, the public had, of course, the opportunity to participate in the shows of punk and hardcore bands: Cólera, Periferia S/A, Positive Youth, Ralph Macchio, and Pushmongos.[81] There was also an unscheduled appearance by the band Test.[82] Pushmongos was the punk rock band of Felipe Madureira, who designed the 2005 poster for 13th São Paulo Hardcore Festival in which the discussion about the revolts against hikes in Florianópolis took place. The members of the broader punk scene assumed several roles throughout the years: designers, musicians, organizers, activists, protesters, scholars.

What do hardcore-punk festivals holding debates on the free fare struggle together with several music shows mean in these historical contexts? It is true that the 2011 Verdurada incorporated the Free Fare Movement as a guest thanks to the protests that were happening in São Paulo.[83] However, in a somewhat unexpected way, that city cannot always be seen at the forefront of a political and cultural movement. As for the 2005 event that also had the free fare struggle as its main point of debate, the Verdurada Collective incorporated the lecture's subject matter as a consequence of the events in a peripheral state capital: Florianópolis. The drawing of the poster (Fig. 5.1) includes the same elements of the Turnstile Revolts of 2004 and 2005 opposing the bus fare hike. In a news report about São Paulo's Hardcore Festival, it was actually stated (even more clearly than in the poster) that the organizers' intention was not only to talk about the issue of the free fare in general terms, but that they specifically wished to discuss Florianópolis' Turnstile Revolts: "In the edition of July [2005], the theme [of the festival] was the struggle for the Free Fare *in Florianópolis.*"[84] The Brazilian metropolis of São Paulo, which de facto dictates most of the directions of the country's modernity, then had to catch up with the train of history to be in synchrony with its much smaller counterpart. The Free Fare Movement did not exclusively radiate from the financial center of the country, but was brought into existence largely on the margins of Brazilian capitalism. As a result of the novelty and size of the revolts, Florianópolis and its militants became the model. As a city, it had lost its air of provincialism.

São Paulo Becomes Florianópolis

After 2004 and 2005, the experiences of Florianópolis' Turnstile Revolts opposing the hikes in the bus fare were exported to and gained momentum in other parts of Brazil. The previous movements and struggles around public transportation—as well as the learning acquired in

[80] Vinicius, *Antes de junho*, 13.

[81] Coletivo Verdurada, "verdurada.junho.2011," Flickr, Apr. 21, 2011, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/5639166537/in/album-72157607271244226/.

[82] Feio, "Verdurada."

[83] Lucas Oliveira (Legume), in conversation with the author, January 2022.

[84] Mariana Albanese and Silvana Salles, "Livra-me da carne," *Revista Viração*, no. 20, Sep. 2005, 14, https://issuu.com/viracao/docs/edicao20 (my emphasis).

Brazil from the process of nationalization of the Free Fare Movement—led more and more cities to create or increase the numbers and quality of their own local social actors who were engaged with urban issues. They operated to confront and to place pressure on their respective municipal governments. Ortellado offers his perspective on the wave of events subsequent to the Turnstile Revolts: "It happened in Florianópolis twice, 2004 and 2005. Later, it happened in several cities; there should have been more than 10 transportation revolts between 2004 until now [2013], perhaps more than 20. And the political institutions were deaf to this process."[85] As with a computer software created by a hacker that spreads uncontrolled from machine to machine, the youth had the banner of the free fare decisively inserted into their own imagery: a hacker working against the operating system of public transportation in the hands of private companies. Toward the end of 2006, more than a year after the second of the revolts in Florianópolis, a series of protests against a fare increase took over São Paulo. The major newspaper in that city (and in Brazil, for that matter), *Folha de São Paulo*, reported that the demonstrations featured a vast variety of left-wing political ideologies. Among the militants, there were punks. A journalist managed to meet one of them:

> Yesterday, the new fare became official, but, in any case, about 1,200 young people from a diverse political spectrum (punks, "ninjas," college students, militants from the Socialism and Freedom Party [PSOL], the Socialist Party of Unified Workers [PSTU], and the Homeless Workers Movement [MTST], dressed-up clowns, and skateboarders) marched from the Municipal Theater to the Sé Square, returning through Líbero Badaró Street and the Chá Viaduct. . . . A "punk" called João, 19, raises the red and black flag from the Spanish National Confederation [CNT]. . . . What is punk? "Not even the sociologists were able to explain it, bro."[86]

The presence of punks at the protests for free public transportation in São Paulo in the mid-2000s cannot be considered a surprise, a coincidence, or an unusual connection. Far from such a representation, there was, in fact, a constructed alliance between those behind the urban social movement and those playing in bands and attending the punk shows of the metropolis. Part of the militant work became the organization of *both* demonstrations *and* shows. On October 22, 2006, the Free Fare Movement of São Paulo staged an event to celebrate the National Week of Struggle for the Free Fare. The chosen motto stated, "Because culture is not a commodity too!," which is a wordplay on the movement's own slogan, "Transportation is not a commodity!" Among activities that involved various types of exhibitions and workshops, there were public presentations by several bands: Violência Sonora (Sound Violence), Juventude Perdida (Lost Youth), Bacantis, Caos Alternativo (Alternative Chaos), Destroyer of Senses, and Mine.[87]

The attractions at this Cultural Free Fare Festival were not chosen arbitrarily. It is possible to recover the radicalization of the sound that emanated from music performances on that day. One of the bands, Violência Sonora, had recorded in 2005 a very primitive demo CD-R composed of eight songs. The track called "Sistema Falido" ("Failed System") helps to display the band's intense anti-capitalist sentiment, with the piece reverberating like an

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[85] Ortellado, "Pablo Ortellado."

[86] Paulo Sampaio, "No dia do reajuste, 1.200 protestam no centro," *Folha de São Paulo*, Dec. 1, 2006, C6.

[87] MPL-SP, "[mpl sp] Impressos e agenda da Semana Nacional de Luta pelo Passe Livre!" *CMI Brasil*, Oct. 12, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20061106080518/http://www.midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/10/362345.shtml.

actual political manifesto. Through its direct discourse, the bourgeoisie, the state, and the economic system are condemned and repelled. The rawness of the recording gives the song an aesthetic of poverty, and, most likely, such an aural appeal was repeated when the song was played live. The working class becomes present through the distortion of sounds. For the Free Fare Movement, the alliance with bands such as Violência Sonora must have signified that its militants were combining forces with the marginality of the excluded. The song even denounces the challenges that the transportation system poses for workers. The fares are so high that sometimes the only option for the poor is to walk for several miles:

[canto]	*[singing]*
[...]	*. . .*
[discurso falado]	*[spoken words]*
Burguesia não é sinônimo de superioridade, mas aqui quem tem dinheiro é quem dá as ordens: os donos de empresas multinacionais, os governantes, os banqueiros, donos de impérios que eles conseguiram, mas às custas de quem? Daquele que acorda cedo e sem dinheiro para o ônibus vai a pé para o trabalho [...]	*Bourgeoisie is no synonym of superiority, but here he who has money gives the orders: the owners of multinational companies, the rulers, the bankers, the owners of empires that they constructed, but at the expense of whom? Of those who wake up early and without anymoney for the bus go to work by foot . . .* [88]

São Paulo's Cultural Free Fare Festival featuring the punk show by Violência Sonora occurred in October 2006, and it served as a prelude to the protests that would take place a few weeks later in the same city. However, not only punks were involved in the demonstrations of that year in São Paulo: the spirit of Florianópolis was present as well. This influence actually took written form in a November pamphlet by the Struggle Front Against the Hike (of which the Free Fare Movement was a constituent). [89] Here is one of the sentences used to call people to take to the streets: "In Florianópolis and Vitória, the population organized itself and stopped the hike." [90] Besides the Struggle Front Against the Hike, demonstrations were organized by at least one other group: the traditional student organizations. Similarly, in this second branch of the protests, the president of the National Students' Union (UNE) also hoped for powerful activities that would emulate the previous storming of two state capitals, Florianópolis and Salvador, something that would, in fact, shake the economic center of the country. [91] But it was when militants in São Paulo, during a violent confrontation with the police, were reported to be using the same methods learned in the previous years through the events of Florianópolis' Turnstile Revolts, that the relatively small city in the south of Brazil

[88] Violência Sonora, "Sistema Falido," track 8 on *Demo tape (cdr demo)*, recorded 2005, audio streaming, https://youtu.be/VVlrGaWJFy8; the transcription of the lyrics is available at Violência Sonora, "Sistema Falido," Letras, accessed Aug. 18, 2022, https://www.letras.mus.br/violencia-sonora/sistema-falido/ (lyrics changed for capitalization, punctuation, and spelling).

[89] "Semana contra o aumento das tarifas em São Paulo," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 27, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427120524/midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366922.shtml, also reproduced at: http://vidasemcatracas.blogspot.com/2006/11/semana-contra-o-aumento-das-tarifas-em.html.

[90] Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento, "[SP] Ato contra o aumento da tarifa no dia 24/11," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 22, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427213825/http://midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366253.shtml.

[91] "Notícia sobre a primeira manifestação contra o aumento em São Paulo," UNE, Nov. 23, 2006 [circulated via e-mail].

proved to be the archetype that was being followed. The influence appeared so strong that an urban legend even appeared in the leading newspaper of the country, *Folha de São Paulo*. It alleged that anarchists would be coming from Florianópolis for the purpose of teaching their comrades in the larger metropolis:

> The leaders from the Front that directs the struggle against the hike of the fare in São Paulo do not hide the fact that their urban mobilization tactic was copied from that which, in Florianópolis in July 2005, managed to impede a hike of 30% that the southern mayor wanted to apply to the bus fare. Nine militants from Santa Catarina transferred themselves to São Paulo in order to help the organization against the hike of the bus fare. They transmit[ted] the winning script of Florianópolis, which is to make a series of demonstrations—day after day, no rest—to force open the doors of buses and to disable turnstiles in order to gain popular support. One of those transferred militants is Guaxinim, from IML, an acronym that, in this case, means Instituto do Motim Libertário [Institute for the Anarchist Mutiny]. An anarchist, he studied contemporary art at the Federal University of Santa Catarina and is now enrolled at the University of São Paulo.[92]

This story appears to be a contribution to the creation of a myth. No reference to this Institute for the Anarchist Mutiny is contained in the many thousands of files from the Independent Media Center website stored at the Internet Archive. The only exceptions are when someone refers to this very news piece published by *Folha de São Paulo* and cited above. Most likely, the person identifying himself as Guaxinim made a joke to have some fun in case an account was later circulated by the traditional media. He could also be part of a group whose intention was to create confusion both inside and outside the movement, as a form of sabotage.[93] For example, he appeared to have posed as a leader of a leaderless movement.[94] It is still relevant, however, that this so-called Guaxinim decided to use Florianópolis as the habitat of a vanguard, from where wiser militants would come to give guidance to their counterparts in São Paulo. At least, it confirms that Florianópolis resided in the national, public imagery as the center of the struggle against bus fare hikes in particular and for free public transportation in general. Such a story sounded credible enough to the newspaper editors and the reporter. However, there was not universal approval of the way in which the movement was portrayed. An activist who participated in the protests, the artist Graziela Kunsch, formally responded to *Folha de São Paulo*. She argued that the movement had no leaders, that no group of almost 10 militants came from Florianópolis to São Paulo to become insurrection instructors, and, at the time, no degree in arts even existed at the Federal University of Santa Catarina, making it impossible to believe Guaxinim had been completely truthful. At the same time, she acknowledged that the Free Fare Movement, now nationalized with a chapter in São Paulo and born, to a great extent, from the previous events in Florianópolis, was effectively a strong force behind the demonstrations in the large metropolis.

> It is not possible for such a person called Guaxinim to be one of the leaders of the movement, because this movement is horizontal, without hierarchies. The demonstration was organized by the Struggle Front Against the Hike, which encompasses student groups from São Paulo and diverse

[92] Laura Capriglione, "Estudantes arrombam ônibus contra a tarifa," *Folha de São Paulo*, Nov. 25, 2006, C8.

[93] Inte, "[São Paulo] Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento das Passagens mostra a sua cara," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 26, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150503194047/midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366846.shtml.

[94] See: [Graziela Kunsch] Versão dos manifestantes, "Resposta à matéria da Folha de S. Paulo sobre ato contra o aumento," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 25, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427221744/http://www.midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366626.shtml.

> social movements around a common objective: to stop the hike. The affirmation that nine leaders from a so-called Institute for the Anarchist Mutiny would have moved from Florianópolis to lead the act is so ridiculous as saying that the young man studied contemporary art at the Federal University of Santa Catarina [UFSC] (where there is no B.A. in arts). The Free Fare Movement (MPL), which is a member of São Paulo's Front and was the greatest catalyst of Florianópolis' protests, was not even mentioned in the news piece.[95]

Kunsch posted this response on the Independent Media Center website. Even though she ultimately sought to have it published by *Folha de São Paulo* or its cybernetic branch (the web portal UOL, as her letter was directed to its ombudsman), the piece was already online and accessible on the Internet without the need for external approval or any kind of intermediaries. It confirms that the activists could now counterargue the depictions of their actions by the mainstream media. If a news item or column debasing them was published, there was a vehicle through which this could be remedied, in part. Additionally, memory of the historical facts could be documented in a much more complex way. Knowledge should travel through many routes, and the dispute about what is true would become an increasingly egalitarian game.

Independent from the veracity of the account of the nine militants who allegedly transferred their activities from Florianópolis to São Paulo, there was real transportation going on between the two cities—if not of actual activist bodies, then at least of political ideas coming especially from the south. Those ideas were infiltrating the most important urban center of the country. In the view of Ortellado, Florianópolis became "the positive model," sometimes being even remembered during transnational dialogs with foreign activists.[96] According to Vinicius, the success of the militants from Florianópolis in blocking the actions of the local government would generate enthusiasm in other cities. No longer would a mayor shove down the people's throats a higher price for riding the bus without facing the possibility of strong resistance. The events in Florianópolis opened a new door for the organization of social movements. They proved that non-hierarchical structures could be as effective as (or perhaps more efficient than) rigid, vertical configurations in certain scenarios.

> Florianópolis' revolt had managed . . . to cancel the hike. The event would reverberate among young militants of other cities and would become as inspiring as [Salvador's] Bus Revolt had been [previously], mainly among the anarchist youth, because of the movement's non-partisan and autonomist character—street assemblies, direct democracy In São Paulo, we certainly find an example of that.[97]

The militants now acted from a stronger standpoint developed in and fed on the praxis of the earlier revolts and their teaching-like circumstances. However, the police also absorbed lessons from the events. The 2004 revolt in Florianópolis was met with what one can consider to be mild repression, while in 2005 the police demonstrated a change in posture, acting much more violently to control the situation. Apart from the idiosyncrasies of local politics that played a role in the adjustment of the police's attitudes, one cannot dispute that the repressive

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[95] [Graziela Kunsch] Versão dos manifestantes, "Resposta à matéria da Folha de S. Paulo sobre ato contra o aumento"; see also: Inte, "[São Paulo] Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento das Passagens mostra a sua cara."

[96] Pablo Ortellado, in conversation with the author, January 2022.

[97] Vinicius, *Antes de junho*, 295 and 311; the influence of Florianópolis' free-fare struggle on other cities is also corroborated by Legume (Lucas Oliveira [Legume], in conver- sation with the author, January 2022); and: Ikuhara Santos, *As bases e fontes de poder no Movimento Passe Livre de Florianópolis*, 58.

state apparatus had acquired more data on how to manage students in an uprising.[98] The government would not be taken by surprise if a decision were made to crush demonstrations; indeed, fierce suppression of protests became a common recurrence. In the protests that took place at the end of 2006 against the fare hike in São Paulo, it was reported that, on November 24, "several people were injured by splinters from sound grenades, rubber bullets, billy clubs, in addition to the use of pepper spray."[99] The police also arrested activists in a showcase of their power.[100] Years later, in January 2010, another round of demonstrations emerged against a fare increase in São Paulo. The protesters took to the streets to display their opposition to the state and to the cost of public transportation. Images circulated of activists being beaten and arrested by the Military Police. Dressed for the occasion, the policemen wore helmets and wielded billy clubs, tear-gas grenades, and pepper spray, putting their weaponry into use (Fig. 5.2).



Fig. 5.2: Marcelo Pereira, In the Turnstile, São Paulo, January 7, 2010. "The Military Police suppress a protest in the bus terminal Parque Dom Pedro against the bus fare hike in São Paulo Close to 200 people, mostly members of the Free Fare Movement, participated in the demonstrations; three were arrested."[101] It is documented by the press that the police arsenal, besides billy clubs, pepper spray, and stun grenades, included "tear gas," and at least one of the policemen is pictured while he openly "holds a firearm" in front of the protesters.[102]

[98] See: Chagas, "Dário pede repressão e governo acata"; Ludd [Vinicius], "A Guerra da Tarifa"; Vinicius, A Guerra da Tarifa, 54–55 and 58–59; Ikuhara Santos, *As bases e fontes de poder no Movimento Passe Livre de Florianópolis*, 62; sociologist Janice Tirelli Ponte de Sousa declared, for example, that just after the Second Turnstile Revolt: "It is even possible that state intelligence agencies, besides the Military Police, are also trying to understand what is going on [in Florianópolis]" (Sousa, "Primeiro bate e depois negocia," 18).

[99] CMI-SP, "[Busão] Repressão em ato contra o aumento da tarifa em São Paulo – I," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 24, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427190548/http://www.midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366512.shtml.

[100] CMI-SP, "[SP] Todos os detidos do ato contra o aumento foram liberados!" *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 25, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427205348/http://midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366567.shtml.

[101] "Na Catraca," Folha de São Paulo, Jan. 8, 2010, C7; see also: "Manifestação contra aumento da tarifa de ônibus acaba em tumulto em SP," G1, Jan. 7, 2010, http://g1.globo.com/Noticias/SaoPaulo/0,,MUL1438798-5605,00.html.

[102] Protesto contra tarifa termina em confronto em SP," UOL Notícias, Jan. 7, 2010, https://noticias.uol.com.

Compared to Florianópolis, the demonstrations in São Paulo seem to have been comprised of older militants who were more likely to engage in direct action, which could have elevated tensions between the protesters and the police. For instance, anarchist flags were displayed at the 2006 protests, which is something apparently not registered in Florianópolis, if one considers the documents consulted here.[103] According to Daniel Guimarães, São Paulo's Free Fare Movement had deeper "anarchist/autonomist" tendencies compared to that of Florianópolis, which featured more links with Marxist organizations.[104] In any case, the repression by the state was unquestionably strong in the main metropolis of the country. A participant in São Paulo's 2006 demonstrations stated his perspective on the police violence: "The indignation is huge with the brutality perpetrated against us, which makes me feel really bad, and I keep asking myself: 'How do they have the nerve to do that? Why?!' This was my first demonstration that ended up like this, with such repression and brutality, and I now wonder about what a shit democracy is this one, which they who are in power are proud to say we live in."[105] One must note that such a criticism of Brazilian democracy was lodged during the left-wing presidential government of Lula, who remained in power from January 2003 through December 2010. Clearly, more radical militants and musicians did not see Lula in a positive light. The repressive stance of the police in São Paulo did not help to lead the activists to believe that a left-wing president would make things easier for them, both in terms of protesting and regarding the achievement of their goals.

In 2009, the 17th São Paulo Hardcore Festival, organized by the Verdurada Collective, hosted two lectures, the first on animal rights and the other on the Free Fare Movement. The talks were accompanied by shows by the bands Confronto, I Shot Cyrus, Red Dons, Eu Serei a Hiena (I Would Be the Hyena), Nossa Vingança (Our Vengeance), Mukeka di Rato (Rat Stew), Naifa, Avalanche, Will Champion, and Corleone.[106] One of those ensembles, Naifa, had recorded in 2008 a song containing sharp criticism of Lula, attacking him over two of his appealing characteristics: his rise from the lower classes and his history as a union leader. Titled "Presidente do povo" ("The President from the People"), the piece was published on an album split with another band called Morto pela Escola (Killed by School). The lyrics of "Presidente do povo" create a narrative of a politician who, in spite of originating in the

br/album/100107protesto_album.jhtm?abrefoto=11; Guilherme Balza, "Protesto contra aumento da passagem de ônibus termina com três detidos e feridos em SP," UOL Notícias, Jan. 7, 2010, https://noticias.uol.com.br/cotidiano/2010/01/07/ult5772u6943.jhtm, also replicated at: https://web.archive.org/ web/20160630045108/http://tarifazero.org/2010/01/page/2/.

[103] CMI-SP, "[São Paulo] Ato da Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 26, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427173621/http://midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366671.shtml; CMI-SP, "[São Paulo] Ato da Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento II," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 26, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427182702/http://midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366692.shtml; CMI-SP, "[São Paulo] Ato da Frente de Luta Contra o Aumento V," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 26, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427180656/http://www.midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366776.shtml.

[104] Guimarães, "Do It Yourcast #20."

[105] Sirley Alencar, "Indignação," comment to: CMI-SP, "[São Paulo] Fotos repressão em São Paulo," *CMI Brasil*, Nov. 25, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20150427185242/http://www.midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2006/11/366572.shtml.

[106] Coletivo Verdurada, "festival.janeiro.2009," Flickr, Dec. 23, 2008, https://www.flickr.com/photos/cartazesverdurada/3264091558/in/album-72157607271244226/.

workers' movement, deceived his constituents and essentially abandoned the poor. Now, he sits at a table with the country's rich and powerful. Here is a fragment of the song:

[…]	. . .
O presidente do povo	*The president from the people*
Lutava com o povo	*Struggled alongside the people*
Brigava pelo povo	*Fought for the people*
Mas se esqueceu do povo	*But he forgot the people*
O presidente do povo	*The president from the people*
Prometeu para o povo	*Made promises to the people*
Mentiu para o povo	*Lied to the people*
E já não é do povo	*And no longer belongs to the people*
[...]	. . .[107]

Criticism of Lula permeates the lyrics despite his proven ability to effectively bring millions out of poverty through reformist (not revolutionary) actions. These actions also caused a set of problems that could be traced to the way in which they were carried out. As posited by Alfredo Saad Filho, social and fiscal measures promoted by Lula during his term as president of Brazil, together with his general achievements when leading the country (according to Lula's own rulebook), provided more people with the opportunity and the means to own a car, which caused the worsening of urban mobility: "Faster economic growth in the 2000s, the distribution of income, and the wider availability of credit and tax breaks to manufacturing industry triggered the explosive growth of automobile sales, while woefully insufficient investment in infrastructure and public transport led to traffic gridlock in many large cities."[108] Thus, the presence in the same hardcore/punk event of a band criticizing Lula and a lecture on the Free Fare Movement displays the spirit of the epoch, especially in a city like São Paulo. There, the streets were saturated with cars containing people fleeing the precarious and costly public transportation system, creating a snowball effect. Those who could abandon the use of buses and the subway for private solutions would do it, but the rising number of vehicles would make enormous traffic jams an ever more common occurrence in everyday life.

The chaotic condition of traffic in general, and not only public transportation in particular, might explain part of the evolution of the Free Fare Movement in São Paulo. The necessity of a better public transportation system became increasingly evident, even for people who managed to afford an automobile. They could not be directly dependent on buses, trains, or the subway, but certainly they were indirectly affected by the lack of options available to navigate the city if the population was considered as a whole. As stated by Mariana S. Mendes: "[The Free Fare Movement's] critique is therefore not only a matter of having free and better

[107] Naifa, "Presidente do povo," track 12 on *Split: Naifa & Morto pela Escola*, recorded 2007/2008, released 2008, audio streaming, https://lajarex.bandcamp.com/album/naifa-e-morto-pela-escola.

[108] Saad Filho, "The Economic Context of Social Protests in 2013."

public transport but also a plea for a more efficient system of circulation and mobility. This is a particularly pressing need in a city like São Paulo, where traffic jams rank among the worst in the world." [109] Starting with those mid-2000s protests, the rage would only grow over the years. In the militants' view, all those who could not pay (or could hardly pay) to use the public transportation system and those who had the means to use a private vehicle were doomed. More cars did not mean a solution. More buses should circulate. More subways needed to be constructed. The access to them must be universal and funded by taxes on the rich. The turnstile had to be destroyed.

Burning Turnstile

Flora Lorena Müller, a Florianópolis militant, once wrote: "The struggle against turnstiles is the struggle for the right to the city." [110] The movement had chosen an object that, unquestionably, had to be eliminated. Bus turnstiles exemplified the worst characteristics of a transportation system that was the focus of the militants' fight. Rooted in another urban context, Gregori, the pioneer who conceptualized the zero fare in the early 1990s and São Paulo's former secretary of transportation, declared that "a turnstile is not only something big and ugly. It can also be a symbol of humiliation." [111] It is humiliating especially for the poor, signifying the impossibility of coming and going through the urban space. Müller and Gregori lived in different cities, but they shared a strong opposition to the same device. Throughout the country, the "burning turnstile" would become the iconic image, the representational metaphor, of the campaign for unrestricted access to the city. [112] Within this campaign, the punk culture became particularly present in the cathartic moment of destruction of these metal barriers. Sometimes, punk existed as a soundtrack: in 2005, Camarada D. (the pen name likely being used by Daniel Guimarães) described a meeting in Florianópolis in which the protesters initiated a demonstration under the soundwaves of this music genre; the protest ended with the militants seeking to reduce two turnstiles to ashes. [113] Other times, punk made itself visible as the provider of bodies to carry out the execution of an anarchic ritual: in São Paulo, turnstiles were ignited with the support and the active vigor of people who identified with the punk movement. There, they would become the front line of the attack (Fig. 5.3).

[109] Mendes, "Brazil's popular awakening," 77.

[110] Flora Lorena [Müller], "Por uma vida sem catracas e sem machismo," in *Tarifa Zero* (Florianópolis: MPL, 2011), 11, https://mplfloripa.wordpress.com/2011/07/01/caderno-de-textos/.

[111] Lúcio Gregori, "Tarifa nos transportes coletivos urbanos: uma iniquidade," in *Tarifa Zero* (Florianópolis: MPL, 2011), 5, https://mplfloripa.wordpress.com/2011/07/01/caderno-de-textos/.

[112] *Jornal Sem Terra*, "A luta por transporte público a favor do povo."

[113] [Camarada] D., "[Floripa] Queima catraca, queima!"



Fig. 5.3 [see opposite]: Marcel Maggion Maia, Demonstration Against the Bus Fare Hike, São Paulo, January 14, 2010.[114] CC BY-NC-SA 2.0. In the background, a young man in black sports a garment from Edinburgh band The Exploited with the cover design of their 1981 album Punks not Dead, which bears a song with the lyrics: "I'm not ashamed of being a punk / And I don't care, I don't give a damn / And I don't care what you say / Cause I believe in anarchy."[115] On the back of the jacket of the protester wearing a mohawk and pouring a flammable liquid over the turnstile, one can read most of the phrase "Êra Punk" and words associated with the international punk music scene, displayed around the pierced skull, referring to the "D-beat," "rawpunk" band Disclose (1991–2007). This band was composed of Japanese members who searched for a musical expression shaped after the English group Discharge and featured anti-war discourses in the lyrics of their songs such as in the piece "Noise Not Music."[116]

As explained by researcher Walisson Pereira Fernandes: "The term 'Êra' is a salute and, at the same time, a war cry used by Brazilian punks since the 1980s. The term really gained momentum in the 1990s, with the creation of São Paulo's East Zone rawpunk movement. As anarcho-punk and hardcore grew in Brazil, several punks felt the necessity to concentrate more on punk culture than anarchist politics; from that, [São Paulo's] rawpunk emerged, created by Márcia, Jaka, and by many others . . . from Punks do Subúrbio [Punks of the Outskirts]. Because of this necessity of highlighting and preserving punk culture, elements such as mohawks, patches, sound structure (D-beat) and

[114] Marcel [Maggion] Maia, "Ato Contra o Aumento do Ônibus em São Paulo," Flickr, Jan. 14, 2010, https://www.flickr.com/photos/panopticosp/4276429774/in/album-72157623087685835/; "A Luta Continua," Rede Contra o Aumento da Tarifa, Jan. 16, 2010, https://barraroaumento.wordpress.com/2010/01/16/a-luta-continua/.

[115] The Exploited, "I Believe in Anarchy," (re)recorded 1981, track B15 on Punks not Dead (Wallingford [UK]: Let Them Eat Vinyl, reissued 2014), vinyl; song's ([re]recording) date information and lyrics cited in Bestley, "Big A Little A," 61–62; Morat, "The Exploited History," The Exploited, Jan. 2003, http://www.the-exploited.net/history.htm.

[116] "About Disclose," Disclose, accessed Apr. 18, 2019, http://disclose.likesyou.org/about.html; "7 inch Records," Disclose, accessed Apr. 18, 2019, http://disclose.likesyou.org/d7in.html; "Lyrics in Alphabetical Order," Disclose, accessed Apr. 18, 2019, http://disclose.likesyou.org/lalpha.html; Disclose and No Fucker, Noise Not Music, released on vinyl in 2004, audio streaming, https://youtu.be/pWmbMwK8uhs; for written examples in which the salute "Êra Punk" is used, see: "Manifesto ruído antifascista," Pânico em CWB, Oct. 2012, http://uniondezesseis.blogspot.com/2012/10/manifesto-ruido-antifascista.html; Mao Punk, Suicídio inconsciente: propostas e reflexões sobre o movimento punk, Jul. 2010, updated Dec. 2015, http://suicidioinconscientepunk.blogspot.com; for historical information about Discharge, see: Chris A. Smith, "Rules of the Tribe: Hardcore Punks and Hair Metal in the 1980s," Appendix, vol. 1, no. 3 (Jul. 2013), http://theappendix.net/issues/2013/7/rules-of-the-tribe-hardcore-punks-and-hair-metal-in-the-1980s; the band Discharge is also characterized by an anti-war discourse (Bestley, "Big A Little A," 63).

> production of zines had a greater emphasis The most convincing theory (raised also by Jaka himself) is that ['Êra'] comes from a song called 'Êra Suburbanos' [by the band Suburbanos, 1982]; it is the consensus that this term was used because of a contraction from the word '*eira*' [threshing floor] as in '*sem eira nem beira*' [literally, without a floor or a roof]." [117]
>
> Still, according to Pereira Fernandes, in São Paulo there was a differentiation between rawpunks, anarcho-punks (from the Anarcho-Punk Movement, also known as MAP), and the people belonging to the hardcore scene: "This does not mean that rawpunks were not anarchists, on the contrary: the majority of rawpunks that I interviewed or were part of my ethnographic work . . . are anarchists. What happens is that we had the creation of the Anarcho-Punk Movement (MAP) in the beginning of the 1990s, and MAP possessed a greater political connotation compared to punk. After some time, politics became a constant, putting aside traits of punk culture (aesthetics) and incorporating patterns with a greater social acceptance: short hair (rather than mohawks), clothes with colors (rather than the nihilistic aesthetics of black), sneakers (rather than combat boots) This is so interesting that I realized, during all those years, that the people from São Paulo's punk [scene], mainly those coming from the more poeticized scene (a.k.a. 'hardcore'), do not use the term 'Êra.' The term is used more by punks from the lower classes and predominantly by rawpunks." [118]

In this modern but tribal-like ceremony of turnstile burning carried out by punks and militants in support of free public transportation, fire—when seen as an element of transformation—carries two implications. On one hand, fire destroys the device that physically impedes São Paulo's youth and poor from enjoying and exploring in a liberated fashion their indigenous environment: the urban space. On the other hand, fire functions as a means of expressing one's rage. It represents fury and indignation against the institutions of power that are acting upon one's life: the turnstile is a mechanical obstruction through which money is collected in exchange for motorized mobility. At the same time, the turnstile represents the administrative bodies of the government as well. As a result, the attack on the turnstile becomes an attack on the state.

The burning turnstile is a mobile metaphor for the struggle for the free fare; it can be transposed to other items and institutions instead of being restricted to only one object, because, according to the social movement itself: "The turnstile repudiated by the Free Fare Movement is also a symbolic one. There are invisible turnstiles all over, not allowing full access to spaces and services. Together, we need to destroy all of them. Through our struggle, we want to build a world in which there is no sort of turnstile." [119] This political statement provided by participants of the Free Fare Movement is basically the proposition of a socialist world, which could be achieved only through the destruction or at least the radical transformation of the status quo.

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[117] Walisson Pereira Fernandes, in correspondence with the author, May 2019; Suburbanos, Demo (1982), recorded 1982, audio streaming, https://youtu.be/_wmLlj38mnY; Suburbanos, "Êra Suburbanos," track B3 on the various artists' compilation, O começo do fim do mundo, recorded live at SESC Pompéia, São Paulo, Nov. 27–28, 1982 (São Paulo: Nada Nada Discos, reissued 2017), box set, vinyl, cassette tape.

[118] Pereira Fernandes, in correspondence with the author, May 2019.

[119] MPL-Florianópolis, "Apresentação," in *Tarifa Zero* (Florianópolis: MPL, 2011), 4, https://mplfloripa.wordpress.com/2011/07/01/caderno-de-textos/; fragment also reproduced at: MPL-Florianópolis, "O que é mobilidade urbana?" (Florianópolis: MPL, 2008), 1, https://web.archive.org/web/20101124214037/http://saopaulo.mpl.org.br/files/cartilha-mobilidade-urbana-versao-4p.pdf; the date of the text "O que é mobilidade urbana?" was established by: Gama, *Por uma vida sem catracas*, 177.

In a 2007 letter signed by the Florianópolis chapter of the Free Fare Movement, and retrieved by Yuri Gama through his academic work, one can understand that the burning of turnstiles—in cases where it evolves to reach its full potential of destroying all forms of access limitations to public transportation—is considered a revolutionary act by the movement: "Historically, the organization of the circulation of the poor population in cities has always been based on very clear class criteria, which impeded the lower classes from fully using the urban space and its public services. . . . This means that [the act of] freeing public transportation from turnstiles takes the shape of a historical revolutionary measure."[120] To put an end to the existence of turnstiles is among the first steps of a revolution. This reasoning can have only one logical outcome: institutions are not safe from the fire that emerges from the movement. This fury can spread from the turnstile to other impediments or state bodies that need to be destroyed through revolution. It is a trigger for much larger achievements on the path to social equality.



Fig. 5.4: Douglas, *Burn Turnstile Burn*, São Paulo, 2005. Copyleft CMI Brasil— Centro de Mídia Independente Brasil (see note for details).[121]

The "Manifesto of the National Meeting for the Free Fare," written in 2004, declared (in a way now transparent to us) that images of burning turnstiles should be just the beginning: "In the most different corners of this country, a spark is setting the hearts and minds of students on fire: it is the Campaign for the Free Fare. *This same spark threatens to set fire to*

[120] MPL-Florianópolis cited in Gama, *Por uma vida sem catracas*, 175–176.

[121] Douglas, "[São Paulo] fotos do ato do dia 27/10 pelo passe livre – parte 2," CMI Brasil, Oct. 29, 2005, https://web.archive.org/web/20150509035811/midiaindependente.org/pt/blue/2005/10/334563.shtml (copyleft http://www.midiaindependente.org: reproduction for non-commercial use is free as long as the author and the source are cited and this note is included).

buses, streets, city council buildings, and offices of mayors."[122] In the following year, this general feeling captured by that declaration became more of a reality; in fact, it was put into practice. The spirit present in the burning of turnstiles by a ritualistic congregation of protesters was momentarily transported to an attempt to burn down Florianópolis' City Council building. As Thais Ikuhara Santos writes, the 2005 Turnstile Revolt in that city reached its pinnacle with the reported number of "10,000 students . . . who blocked Paulo Fontes, Mauro Ramos, and Beira-mar avenues; they invaded and closed terminals, chained themselves to the mayor's office building, and *even set fire to the City Council building, too."*[123] In São Paulo, hundreds of miles north, every time a turnstile was set on fire then, the act should function as a warning to the politicians in charge. As it happened in Florianópolis, one day it will be the palaces of the larger metropolis that will burn. The critical issue is: were those politicians paying enough attention? Or were they deaf to the noise of protests?

[122] CPL, "A recente história da campanha pelo passe-livre em Fpolis," 28 (my emphasis).

[123] Ikuhara Santos, *As bases e fontes de poder no Movimento Passe Livre de Florianópolis*, 62 (my emphasis).